THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH FULL SYLLABUS PAPER SET 03

Reading · Writing & Grammar · Literature (First Flight, Poetry, Footprints Without Feet) | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours 15 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A (Reading, 20 marks): Q. 1–2, passages with 10 sub-questions each (1 mark each).
3. Section B (Writing, 12 marks): Q. 3 Notice (3), Q. 4 Letter (5), Q. 5 Analytical paragraph (4).
4. Section C (Grammar, 8 marks): Q. 6–13 (1 mark each).
5. Section D–G (Literature, 40 marks): Q. 14–21 objective (1 mark each), Q. 22–24 extract-based (4 marks each), Q. 25–28 short answer (2 marks each), Q. 29–32 long answer (3 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 3, 4, 5 and Q. 29 to 32.
7. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading: 20 Marks) — 20 Marks

Read the passages and answer the questions that follow.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

In many Indian villages, the arrival of the monsoon is still greeted like the arrival of a guest of honour. The first drops are welcomed, the soil is smelt, and everyone watches the sky. Yet when the guest departs, very little is kept for later. Most of the rain flows away through drains and rivers to the sea, and by April the same people are standing in queues with empty pots.

Rainwater harvesting is an old answer to this problem. In the deserts of Rajasthan, families built tanks known as tankas under their courtyards and carefully directed the water from their roofs into them. A well-kept tanka could keep a family supplied for months, and no one called it a 'scheme'; it was simply what sensible people did. Over the years, as pipes and pumps arrived, these tanks were forgotten. Taps gave water without effort, and effort was soon forgotten too.

Today the taps are failing. The level of groundwater has fallen in many places because we draw more than the earth can give back. Wells have gone dry and deeper borewells have to be dug at greater cost. Experts say that the solution is not a single grand project but thousands of small ones: a pit near a house, a pond in a village, a cleaned-up lake in a town.

Young people can lead the change. A school roof that is connected to a storage tank can supply the garden for the whole year. A family can mend leaking taps, which waste several litres a day, and water plants with the water used for washing vegetables. These are small acts, but when a whole neighbourhood repeats them, a river of saving begins to flow.

(i) The writer compares the monsoon to: 1

(a) a teacher **(b)** a festival
(c) an enemy **(d)** a guest of honour

(ii) What is a tanka? 1

(a) A river **(b)** A borewell
(c) A tank built under a courtyard to store rainwater **(d)** A kind of pump

(iii) Why were the old storage tanks forgotten? 1

(a) They were costly **(b)** They were banned
(c) They were unsafe **(d)** Taps gave water without effort

(iv) The fall in groundwater level is caused because we: 1

(a) get too much rain **(b)** draw more than the earth can give back
(c) plant trees **(d)** build tanks

(v) Experts say that the solution is: 1

(a) one grand project **(b)** importing water
(c) closing wells **(d)** thousands of small projects

(vi) What happens to most rainwater in India according to the passage? 1

(vii) Why was a tanka important to a Rajasthan family? 1

(viii) Mention one way a family can save water. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'to send in a particular direction'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'the opposite of arrive'. 1

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Green Committee of a town measured the monthly rainfall and the quantity of rainwater stored by a school with a harvesting tank in the monsoon months.

Month	Rainfall (mm)	Water stored (thousand litres)
June	120	30
July	320	80
August	280	70
September	180	45

(i) In which month was the rainfall highest? 1

(a) September **(b)** June **(c)** July **(d)** August

(ii) How much water was stored in August? 1

(a) 30 thousand litres **(b)** 45 thousand litres

(c) 80 thousand litres **(d)** 70 thousand litres

(iii) The total water stored in the four months was: 1

(a) 225 thousand litres **(b)** 180 thousand litres

(c) 200 thousand litres **(d)** 250 thousand litres

(iv) How much more rain fell in July than in June? 1

(v) How much water is stored for every 4 mm of rain? 1

(vi) Which month gave the least stored water? 1

(vii) Why would the tank be useful in the dry months? 1

(viii) What is the total rainfall in the four months? 1

(ix) Suggest one use of the stored water in school. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'collecting and keeping'. 1

SECTION — B (Writing Skills: 12 Marks) — 12 Marks

Internal choice is given in each question.

3. The school is organising an Educational Trip to Delhi. Write a notice in not more than 50 words. You are the Class Teacher of Class 10. 3

OR

A school vehicle bus will change its route next week. Write a notice in not more than 50 words informing students and parents. You are the Transport In-charge. 3

4. You are Amit/Amita of 6, Ratanada, Jodhpur. Write a letter to the Principal, in about 120 words, requesting the school to arrange extra classes in Mathematics for weak students. 5

OR

You are Seema/Sameer. Write a letter to a friend, in about 120 words, describing a fair that you visited recently. 5

5. Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'My Aim in Life'. 4

OR

Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'The Evils of Plastic'. 4

SECTION — C (Grammar: 8 Marks) — 8 Marks

Attempt all the questions.

6. Fill in the blank with the correct form: The train _____ (already/leave) before we reached. 1

7. Choose the correct modal: You _____ speak softly in the library. (must / can / will) 1

8. Fill in the blank with the correct preposition: She is good _____ music. 1

9. Rewrite in reported speech: The boy said, "I have lost my pen." 1

10. Change into passive voice: The police arrested the thief. 1

11. Join using 'if': Work hard. You will succeed. 1

12. Find and correct the error: She said me that she was ill. 1

13. Rearrange to form a meaningful sentence: early / the / bird / worm / catches / the 1

SECTION — D (Literature: Objective Type) — 8 Marks

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

14. Anne's father emigrated to Holland in: 1

(a) 1942 **(b)** 1933 **(c)** 1926 **(d)** 1929

15. The old-time baker's dress was a single-piece long frock called the: 1

(a) dhoti **(b)** pader **(c)** kuppia **(d)** kabai

16. In 1956 Maxwell travelled to: 1

(a) France **(b)** Southern Iraq **(c)** India **(d)** Egypt

17. The leopard is recognised by its: 1

(a) spotted hide and repeated leaps **(b)** stripes
(c) mane **(d)** tusks

18. Where did the ball go? 1

(a) Under a car **(b)** Into the harbour water
(c) Into a drain **(d)** Into a garden

19. Horace served his first and only sentence in a: 1

(a) farm **(b)** prison library **(c)** factory **(d)** police station

20. Why did Griffin set fire to the house? 1

(a) He wanted to test invisibility
(b) His landlord disliked him and tried to eject him
(c) He wanted to escape the police
(d) He lost his money

21. His article was special because: 1

(a) the journal had never before published the work of college students
(b) it was written by his mother
(c) it won a prize
(d) it was very long

SECTION — E (Literature: Extract-based Questions) — 12 Marks

Read the extracts and answer the questions that follow.

22. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> The air hostess smiled and suggested that Maxwell keep the pet on his knee. Mij had no intention of staying there. He leapt out of the box and sped down the aircraft, causing shrieks. A woman screamed 'A rat!' and a stout passenger had curry spilled over Maxwell's face as he dived after the animal. The hostess calmly asked him to return to his seat while she looked for the animal.

(i) What did the air hostess suggest? 1

(ii) Why did the woman scream 'A rat!'? 1

(iii) What happened when Maxwell dived for Mij? 1

(iv) How did the hostess react to the chaos? 1

23. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> The poem opens with the trees inside the house moving out into the forest, which has been empty for days and nights. Without trees, no bird could sit, no insect could hide, and the sun had no shadow to rest in. By morning the forest will be full of trees.

(i) Where are the trees moving? 1

(ii) What was missing in the empty forest? 1

(iii) When will the forest be full? 1

(iv) Name one thing a treeless forest lacks. 1

24. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> Two boys saw fresh muddy imprints of bare feet on the steps of a house in London. Then a new footprint appeared from nowhere. They followed the prints down the street until they grew faint and disappeared. The explanation was simple. They had been following a scientist who had discovered how to make the human body transparent.

(i) What did the boys see on the steps? 1

(ii) Why did the footprints disappear? 1

(iii) Who had made the footprints? 1

(iv) What is meant by 'transparent'? 1

SECTION — F (Literature: Short Answer Type) — 8 Marks

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

25. Why did the Buddha ask Kisa Gotami for mustard seed? 2

26. Why did Lencho say the raindrops were like new coins? 2

27. Why did the others laugh at Custard? 2

28. Why did Mme Loisel borrow the necklace? 2

SECTION — G (Literature: Long Answer Type) — 12 Marks

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

29. How does Anne feel about her father, grandmother, Mrs Kuperus and Mr Keesing? 3

OR

What does the play say about marriages among rich families? 3

30. Describe Ebright's science-fair projects in different years. 3

OR

What kind of person is Mr Herriot? Support your answer. 3

31. 'It requires such depths of oppression to create such heights of character.' Explain with reference to the text. 3

OR

What does the story show about trust? 3

32. Describe how the poet identifies the wild animals in the poem. 3

OR

Write a short note on the form and style of 'Fog'. 3

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 80 Marks